✨ AI Friday

From Local to Live in 5 Minutes.

Building and shipping a Claude Code plugin for Replit onboarding.

Gerardo Collante · April 2026

The Problem

🔒 Manual access

Ping Mario on #ask-mario every time someone needs Replit access

📭 No onboarding

No guide, no tutorial — people don't know where to start

😵 Lost developers

Multiple people have lost access or can't find the workspace

📉 Low adoption

Replit is approved but most Yaleros have never deployed an app

💡 The Idea

What if an agent could
do the whole thing for you?

```
/yalo-replit:wizard
```

One command. Access check → project setup → deploy → live URL.

What We Built

ONBOARDING

/yalo-replit:wizard

7-phase flow from access check to live deployment. Handles GitHub, Replit config, and guides the user through every step.

DEPLOY

/yalo-replit:deploy

Triggered by "ready" or "deploy". Commits, pushes, tells you to click Redeploy. One command to go live.

Stack: SKILL.md — natively supports dropdowns, Slack MCP, Bash. No Python runtime needed.

Why SKILL.md over Agent SDK

SKILL.md ✅	Python Agent SDK
Native AskUserQuestion dropdowns	Needs Python runtime
Native MCP tools (Slack, GitHub)	Needs separate packaging
Runs inside Claude Code	Needs API keys
Zero runtime dependencies	Overkill for a wizard flow
Distributable as a plugin	

The 8 Phases

1 Access check → Slack to Mario if needed auto
2 Project setup — template or from scratch auto
3 Build together — iterate until happy auto
4 Looker MCP setup — connector + skill install auto mandatory if data
5 GitHub repo or ZIP for non-GitHub users auto
6 Replit config (.replit + replit.nix) auto
7 Import to Replit browser
8 Click Deploy browser

Build Together

The wizard doesn't just set up a pipeline. It helps you build your app.

📊

Dashboard

Charts, metrics, filters

Data via Looker MCP · never BQ

🤖

AI Tool

LLM-powered apps

🛠️

Internal Tool

Forms & workflows

💡

Your Idea

Anything you want

Iterate: write code → preview → tweak → repeat → "looks great, let's publish"

Data Policy — Mandatory

All data flows through the Looker MCP. No direct BigQuery — ever.

✅ Do

- `mcp__looker-mcp-toolbox__*` at build time
- `looker_sdk` + Replit Secrets for live runtime
- CSV snapshots exported via Looker MCP
- Static sources (external APIs, CSVs)

🚫 Don't

- `bq query` or the `bq` CLI
- `google-cloud-bigquery` SDK
- Any direct BigQuery client
- Hardcoded credentials in `app.py`

Why: Looker enforces metric definitions, row-level security, and audit trails. Direct BQ bypasses all of that.

Two Paths to Replit

With GitHub

Agent creates repo → pushes code

User imports from GitHub in Replit

`git push` → Redeploy for updates

Best for ongoing projects

Without GitHub

Agent creates ZIP file

User uploads at replit.com/import

Drag & drop for updates

Best for quick one-offs

Lessons Learned

Things that broke along the way.

🐍 Python in Nix

`uv run` needs `python311Full` in the Nix env — it's not there by default.

📦 libstdc++ for numpy

numpy/pandas need `pkgs.stdenv.cc.cc.lib` + `LD_LIBRARY_PATH`.

🔀 Replit modifies your files

Always `git pull --rebase` before pushing. Replit adds workflows and ports config.

📋 Ship Replit's own config

Copy the exact `.replit` that Replit generates. Don't fight it.

🎬 Live Demo

Let's build and deploy
something real.

`/yalo-replit:wizard`

Access check → template → dashboard → iterate → publish → live URL

The Deploy Cycle

After initial setup, the daily flow is:

`app.py` `"ready"`

5	2	1
phases automated	browser steps (one-time)	click per deploy

How to Install

```
# One time setup
/plugin marketplace add GerardoYalo/replit-yalo-wizard
/plugin install yalo-replit
/reload-plugins
```

```
# Run the wizard
/yalo-replit:wizard

# Deploy updates
/yalo-replit:deploy
```

Build Your Own Plugin

This same pattern works for any internal tool.

🎓 Onboarding wizards
Replit, GitHub, Datadog, any tool

📊 Data dashboards
Looker MCP → Streamlit → Replit → shareable URL

💬 Slack bots
Automated messages via MCP

⚡ Code generators
Templates, scaffolding, boilerplate

Key Takeaways

1. **SKILL.md > Agent SDK** for wizard-style flows in Claude Code
2. **Plugins are easy to distribute** — marketplace + 2 install commands
3. **The wizard should own the flow** — do the work, don't just instruct
4. **Be honest about manual steps** — set expectations upfront
5. **Ship the config Replit expects** — don't fight the platform

Questions? 🤔

REPO	REPLIT ACCESS	TICKET
GerardoYalo/ replit-yalo-wizard	#ask-mario	YI-3728

Thanks! 🚀

Built entirely with Claude Code — including this presentation.